



PRESENTATION

TEAM 4 FINAL PROJECT

Jialin, Maura, Weiguo, Peini, Ido



Wells Fargo

- **Major U.S. financial services organization**

- Wealth and Investment Technology Division
- Develops systems for financial advisor system, wealth management and risk monitoring
- ~50 employees and multiple project teams
- Primary contact location: Charlotte, North Carolina

- **Company access**

- Interviews conducted with:
 - ➡ Jan Yang (Director – management perspective)
 - ➡ Naren Vazral (Analyst – employee perspective)
- Provided insight into organizational goals, workflow and key challenges.



Output Problem

Main output

- Projects are frequently **problem** completed later than planned
- Gap between expected timelines and actual delivery

Impact

- Reduces efficiency and time-to-market
- Delays value delivery to clients
- Increases workload pressure on employees

Key Causes

- Unclear project scope
- Incomplete system requirements
- Inaccurate resource estimation

Perspectives

- **Managers:** focus on performance, deadlines, and efficiency
- **Employees:** experience workload pressure and unclear expectations

Data Collection Method

Stage 1 **Initial Interview** **Feb 15, 2026**

- Identified the main output problem
- Explored potential causes (approval delays, communication issues, workload distribution)

Stage 2 **Quantitative Data Collection** **Mar 1 - Mar 10, 2026**

- Collected key performance data from internal records and reports
- Metrics include:
 - Delay rate (%)
 - Average delay duration
 - Time spent in approval processes (risk & compliance stages)

Stage 3 **Follow-up Interview** **Mar 15, 2026**

- Confirmed consistency between qualitative insights and quantitative findings
- Ensured perspectives from both management and employees were aligned



Goal: Understand the causes and impact of project delays through reliable and comprehensive data.

Summary of Interview Data

Project-Level Causes



Unclear Project Scope

Scope is not clearly defined at the beginning, leading to adjustments and rework.



Incomplete Requirements

Requirements are not always complete or detailed, causing misunderstandings and rework.



Inaccurate Resource Estimation

Estimates are often inaccurate, making it difficult to set realistic deadlines and allocate time.

Structural & Workflow Issues



Multiple Approval Layers

Matrix structure and risk/compliance reviews create multiple approval steps that slow down progress.



Frequent Requirement Changes

Changes during development lead to additional work and timeline extensions.



High Time Spent on Coordination

Employees spend about 40% of their time on coordination and communication instead of core development.



Key Insight

According to interviewees,
~45%
of project are delayed

Course Concept: Goal Setting Theory

Core Issue

- Gap in goal setting process
- 45% of project delays are caused by poor goal setting and not poor performance

Why Goal Setting Theory?

- Specifically SMART goals and MBO framework
- Ensures that goals are realistic and achievable
- Fixes mismatch between planned deadlines and actual workflow

Current Failures

- No employee involvement in goal creation
- Frequent management changes and alignment meetings reduce efficiency
- Goals are driven by market expectations and not operational

reality

Key Takeaway

- Improving goal setting through using goal setting theory (SMART + MBO) addresses the root cause of project delays by making the goals more realistic, collaborative, and aligned with actual workflows

Methods for Quantifying the Severity of the Output Problem

1. Delay Rate

Measures how frequently delays occur across all completed projects

Formula:

$$\text{Delay Rate} = D / T \times 100\%$$

D = number of delayed projects

T = total number of completed projects

2. Average Delay

Measures how severe each delay is

Formula:

$$\text{Average Delay} = \Sigma(A_i - P_i) / D$$

A_i = actual completion time

P_i = planned completion time

Helps distinguish minor overruns from more disruptive delays

3. Approval Ratio

Measures the extent to which approval processes contribute to project delays

Formula:

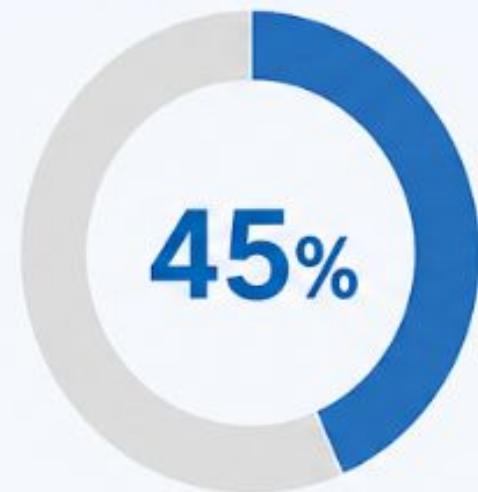
$$\text{Approval Ratio} = AT / TT \times 100\%$$

AT = approval time

TT = total project time

Quantifying and Analyzing the Severity of the Output Problem

1 Severity



- Delay rate = **45%**
- Nearly half of projects are delayed

2 Benchmark



- 31% successful
- 50% challenged
- 19% failed

→ The division falls within the **challenged** performance range.

3 Root Causes

-  Unrealistic timelines
-  Approval delays
-  40% time in meetings
-  Matrix structure bottlenecks



4 Target



- Reduce delay rate to **22%**
- Improve planning and reduce coordination overhead



Recommendations



● Core Initiative: Participatory Goal-Setting

- Collaborative Planning: Technical staff must actively participate in determining project schedules before work begins.
- MBO Integration: Transition from directive, top-down goal assignment to a collaborative Management by Objectives (MBO) framework to bridge the gap between management intentions and operational capabilities.

SMART Framework Implementation

- Achievable & Realistic Timelines: Require that all project schedules formally incorporate the documented 45% delay rate and the extended timelines necessary for risk and compliance approvals.
- Resource Awareness: Use ground-level technical input to identify implementation constraints and bottlenecks that are currently ignored during executive planning

Proven Industry Precedents

Organization	Strategy	Outcome
Intel	OKRs: Objectives established cooperatively rather than imposed from above. (Objective key results)	Timelines that are ambitious yet attainable.
Adobe	Check-Ins: Managers and employees jointly define and modify expectations.	Quantifiable decrease in voluntary employee turnover.
Microsoft	Ownership Culture: Teams voluntarily define success within complex structures.	Restored ability to execute across broad, cross-functional teams.



THANK YOU

